



TIPS & TRICKS



Use the 'Up' arrow key to search through the *bash* command history

You can enable the 'Up' arrow of your keyboard to search through commands that you have used in the past, on the terminal. Just type the initial few letters of the desired command and press the 'Up' arrow, and you will get the commands that start with the letters you have typed.

To enable this search, you have to add the following lines at the end of your *.bashrc* file, which is stored in your home directory.

```
$bind '"\e[A": history-search-backward'
$bind '"\e[B": history-search-forward'
```

And then run the following command:

```
$source ~/.bashrc
```

For example, if your *bash* history contains the following:

```
python2.7 script.py
perl script.pl
php sample.php
perl test.pl
python2.7 sample.py
python2.7 very_long_file_name.py
```

And if you want to search for a *python2.7* command, then enter 'py' and press the 'Up' arrow. The terminal will show commands that start with *py*, one at a time. You can keep pressing the 'Up' arrow to search until the terminal shows the desired command.

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Find and remove duplicate files

It is a very common requirement to remove duplicate files. If you have a large collection of files, then finding and removing such duplicate files will be a tedious task. But this is where GNU/Linux makes the difference—it provides the 'fdupes' utility, which finds duplicate files

by comparing their check-sum.

Let us install the 'fdupes' command using an aptitude package manager:

```
[bash]$ sudo apt-get install fdupes
```

Now, let's suppose that we have a large collection of files and we want to remove all duplicate files. We can use the 'fdupes' command with the '-d' option, which displays the list of duplicate files and prompts users to select which files they want to preserve. Let us check it out with an example.

First create a few duplicate files.

```
[bash]$ for i in {1..10}; do echo "Opensource For You." >
f${i}.txt ; done
```

Now find and remove them.

```
[bash]$ fdupes -d .
```

```
[1] ./f2.txt
[2] ./f3.txt
[3] ./f5.txt
[4] ./f9.txt
[5] ./f6.txt
[6] ./f8.txt
[7] ./f4.txt
[8] ./f1.txt
[9] ./f10.txt
[10] ./f7.txt
```

```
Set 1 of 1, preserve files [1 - 10, all]: 1 # Preserve
only one copy of file
```

```
[+] ./f2.txt
[-] ./f3.txt
[-] ./f5.txt
[-] ./f9.txt
[-] ./f6.txt
[-] ./f8.txt
```